

830,000 m² of green land built over?

A newsroom's satellite estimate, tested against its own map and an independent land-cover model

THE CLAIM

“Nearly 830,000 square metres of nature and cropland have been built up in Malta between 2018 and 2023.”

Amphora Media, *Green to Grey*, 11 September 2026

The press is held to the same standard as everyone else.

Companion piece: “nearly 95%” of it was farmland.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

*Matches its own map;
not independently confirmed.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

0.83 km²

Amphora's map adds up

Its 397 published polygons cover 828,429 m²: “nearly 830,000” is exact.

2–3%

Little overlap

of an independent model's new built-up land falls inside Amphora's polygons.

96%

Farmland, if grass counts

Cropland plus grass, of the area with a known 2018 class; 37% has no class.

0.26%

Arithmetic checks out

Share of Malta's land; 116 pitches; a quarter to 0.3 of Comino.

93.7 ha

EEA figures check out

New artificial land 2012–2018 in the EEA's change maps; Amphora quotes 92 ha.

FAIR TO SAY

Amphora published its map, so anyone can check it. The independent model is noisy and may be the one that is wrong about 2018.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ Basis of the 95% figure.

☐ Imagery year: 2023 or 2025?

☐ Class of the unknown 37%.

☐ Development-zone status.